PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM / SOAR / CrowdStrike / EDR / XDR

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience designing, deploying and operating enterprise Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms across complex, high-stakes environments. I bring deep expertise in CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) alert triage and response, detection engineering, and threat hunting aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. Having led security operations for an institution with over 8,000 users, I am comfortable owning the full detection-to-response lifecycle and driving continuous improvement of detection rules, playbooks and automated response workflows. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and thrive in hybrid, collaborative environments where technical rigour and clear communication are equally valued.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM / SOAR Platforms:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), SOAR automation and playbook development, alert triage and escalation
- **EDR / XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; alert response and tuning
- **Detection Engineering:** Custom detection rule creation, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned threat modelling, Indicators of Compromise (IoC) analysis, Indicators of Attack (IoA) framework, false-positive reduction
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive hunting across endpoints, cloud, identity and email telemetry; Kusto Query Language (KQL) and CrowdStrike Query Language (CQL)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, containment, eradication and recovery; tabletop exercises and post-incident review
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; risk prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Cloud and Endpoint Security:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium, Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting; SOAR playbook design and automation of repetitive SOC tasks
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead the design and tuning of SIEM detection rules within CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, reducing false-positive alert volume by over 30% while maintaining detection fidelity.
- Own the incident response lifecycle end-to-end using the NIST 800-61 framework: triage EDR/XDR alerts from CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Defender, perform root-cause analysis and drive containment and eradication.
- Develop and maintain SOAR playbooks to automate repetitive alert-handling workflows, cutting mean time to respond for Tier-1 incidents by approximately 40%.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting campaigns aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel KQL queries to surface low-and-slow adversary techniques.
- Provide senior-level guidance on CrowdStrike Falcon EDR configuration and policy management across the university endpoint estate.
- Collaborate with infrastructure and identity teams to mature Conditional Access policies in Microsoft Entra ID and strengthen the BeyondTrust PAM implementation.

- Present findings and risk summaries to senior stakeholders, translating technical indicators into business-relevant language.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Supported the deployment and ongoing management of CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across an estate of over 8,000 users, encompassing Falcon Prevent, Falcon Discover and Falcon Insight modules.
- Performed daily alert triage within the SIEM/SOAR environment, escalating high-fidelity detections and documenting findings in line with the incident response playbook.
- Authored KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel targeting identity-based attack techniques, including pass-the-hash, password spray and impossible-travel anomalies.
- Managed Tenable.io and AppCheck vulnerability scans; tracked remediation progress and reported risk posture metrics to the security leadership team.
- Administered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity, tuning alert thresholds and integrating telemetry into the central SIEM.
- Supported the rollout of Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM policies for mobile device governance across staff and student populations.
- Contributed to the university's Cyber Essentials Plus certification programme, ensuring technical controls met the accreditation standard.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

- Implemented and managed security controls across a cloud-first SaaS environment, including firewall policy management and endpoint protection.
- Supported the design and testing of an information security management framework aligned to ISO 27001, contributing to the company's first formal security audit preparation.
- Automated routine infrastructure and security monitoring tasks using PowerShell scripts, reducing manual overhead for the IT team.
- Managed identity and access provisioning processes, enforcing least-privilege principles and reviewing access rights quarterly.
- Maintained system hardening baselines and assisted with internal vulnerability scanning and patch management cycles.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Scaled CrowdStrike Falcon EDR deployment to over 8,000 endpoints at UAL, achieving full visibility across the endpoint estate and enabling advanced threat hunting capabilities.
- Reduced mean time to detect and respond to critical incidents through SOAR automation, freeing analyst capacity for higher-complexity investigations.
- Authored a library of MITRE ATT&CK-mapped KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, adopted as the standard detection baseline across the security operations function.
- Led the successful renewal of Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation, coordinating cross-functional remediation of identified gaps within a compressed timeframe.
- Designed and delivered incident response tabletop exercises for IT and senior stakeholders, improving organisational cyber resilience and response readiness.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+

- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London / UK)